

HS 252: Introduction to Psychology

Course Code	HS 252
Course Name	Introduction to Psychology
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Teacher's Consent
Intended for	B.Tech
Distribution	Elective
One-time approval	14th BoA (Sep 2016); 14th Senate (Oct 2017)

Course Contents

- **Nature of Psychology** [2 Lectures]
 - Adding to what we know: The process of psychological research.
- **A brief history of psychology** [2 Lectures]
 - Psychology's family tree
- **Biopsychology** [2 Lectures]
 - Concepts of biopsychology, reductionism,
 - Neuron, synapses, neurotransmitters, nervous system, Hemisphere function
- **Learning** [4 Lectures]
 - Classical Conditioning: Learning Predictable Signals
 - Operant Conditioning: Learning what does what.
 - Observational Learning: Learning from the behaviour and outcomes of others.
- **Cognitive Processes** [4 Lectures]
 - Nature, emergence and stages, methods of study
- **Attention and Consciousness** [6 Lectures]
 - Types: Selective, Divided and sustained
 - Theories: Early and late selection, Capacity and Mental efforts model
 - Consciousness
- **Memory** [5 Lectures]
 - What is memory?
 - Sensory Memory, Short term memory, and working Memory
 - Long Term Memory: Where past lives live!
- **Perception** [6 Lectures]
 - Attention- What is attention? Methods of studying attention.
 - Perceptual Constancies and Perceptual Organization.
 - Psychophysics, Theory of Signal Detection, Pattern/Object Perception and recognition)
- **Individual Differences** [7 Lectures]
 - Theories of Intelligence; The most(!) controversial concept in Psychology.
 - The measurement of intelligence.
 - Nature vs. Nurture Debate.
 - The Psychodynamic Perspective: Excavating the iceberg, the Trait perspective, Learning Theory Perspective; Social-Cognitive Theory, the Humanistic Existential Perspective; the Socio-Cultural Personality
 - Assessing Personality.
 - Genetic and Environmental Component in Various Psychological Processes.
- **Affective Processes: Emotions**
 - Emotions: Adding Colour to life.
 - Theories of Emotions. [4 Hours]

Text Books

1. Baron, Robert A (2002). Psychology (5th Edition). Allyn and Bacon

Recommended Reading:

1. Zimbardo and Gerrig, **Psychology and Life**, Prentice Hall
2. Coon, D., & Mitterer, J.O., **Introduction to psychology: Gateways to mind and behaviour**, Wadsworth (Cengage Learning).
3. Atkinson and Hilgard's **Introduction to Psychology**, Cengage Learning.